

Word family: **become / becomes / became / become / becoming**

Base word: become

Third-person singular: becomes

Past tense: became

Past participle: become

** -ing form:** becoming

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective in a separate use (形容詞用法 : becoming)

Useful constructions/extensions: become tired, become difficult, become a teacher, become friends, become aware, become clear, become of, what became of, becoming clothes, becoming manner

Your passage contains:

> “I also admire the way she has handled hardship in life without **becoming bitter**.”

Here, **become** means:

to change from one state into another; to begin to be something.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **becoming bitter**

your grandmother was not originally being described as bitter.

The sentence means that hardship could have changed her emotional state so that she:

* became resentful;

* became angry with life;

* became emotionally hardened.

But that change did **not** happen.

Meaning: To begin to have a new quality, condition, or state.

繁體中文 : ** **變得 ; 開始成為某種狀態

**中文翻譯 : **

> “without becoming bitter”

「沒有因此**變得怨恨 / 憤世嫉俗**」

So:

****become + adjective = 變得.....****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****become + adjective = change into a new state (變得.....) — 變成某種狀態****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To begin to have a particular quality or condition.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She faced hardship without ****becoming bitter****.”

「她面對困境，卻沒有****變得怨恨****。」

Practice 2

> “The weather ****became colder****.”

「天氣****變冷了****。」

Practice 3

> “He gradually ****became more confident****.”

「他逐漸****變得更有自信****。」

****become + adjective = 狀態由原來的情況轉變成新的性質 / 狀況****

2. ****become tired/angry/calm/etc. (變得疲倦 / 生氣 / 冷靜) — 狀態轉變****

Practice 4

> “She ****became tired**** after the long walk.”

「長途步行後，她****變累了****。」

Practice 5

> “He became angry when he heard the news.”

「他聽到消息後**變得生氣**。」

****become = 某人的身體、情緒或心理狀態發生改變****

3. ****become difficult/easy/important (變得困難 / 容易 / 重要) — 情況改變****

Practice 6

> “The problem ****became more difficult****.”

「問題****變得更困難****。」

Practice 7

> “Communication became easier over time.”

「溝通隨時間****變得更容易****。」

****become = 事情、情況或問題的性質逐漸改變****

4. ****become clear/obvious (變得清楚 / 明顯) — 逐漸顯現****

A very common abstract construction.

Practice 8

> “It soon ****became clear**** that we needed more time.”

「很快就****變得很清楚****，我們需要更多時間。」

Practice 9

> “The difference became obvious.”

「差別****變得明顯****。」

****become clear/obvious = 原本不明顯 / 不確定的事情逐漸可以看出 / 理解****

5. **become aware (開始意識到) — 意識到 ; 察覺**

A common mental-state construction.

Practice 10

> “She **became aware** of the problem.”

「她開始**意識到**這個問題。」

Practice 11

> “I became aware that someone was watching me.”

「我開始**察覺到**有人在看我。」

become aware = 由不知道 / 未察覺轉變為知道 / 察覺

6. **become known/famous/popular (變得有名 / 流行) — 成名 ; 變得受歡迎**

Practice 12

> “The café **became popular** very quickly.”

「這間咖啡店很快就**變得受歡迎**。」

Practice 13

> “She became famous after the film.”

「她在電影上映後**成名了**。」

become + status adjective = 由原本狀態轉變成具有某種社會 / 公眾狀態

7. **become = enter a new role/identity (成為) — 成為 ; 當上**

A major separate use.

Meaning: To start to be a particular kind of person, professional, or role.

Practice 14

> “She **became a teacher**.”

「她**成為了一名老師**。」

Practice 15

> “He became the manager last year.”

「他去年**當上了經理**。」

become + noun = 開始擁有某種身份、角色、職業或地位

8. **become a parent/teacher/leader (成為某種身份) — 成為**

Practice 16

> “She **became a mother** at thirty.”

「她三十歲時**成為母親**。」

Practice 17

> “He became team leader.”

「他**成為隊長 / 團隊領導**。」

become + role noun = 身份 / 職位由不是 X 轉變為 X

9. **become friends (成為朋友) — 關係改變**

A common relational use.

Practice 18

> “We **became friends** at university.”

「我們在大學時**成為朋友**。」

Practice 19

> “The two families became close.”

「兩個家庭後來**變得親近**。」

become = 人際關係由原本狀態轉變為新的關係 / 程度

10. **become part of / member of (成為其中一部分 / 成員) — 加入 ; 成為**

Practice 20

> “She **became part of the team**.”

「她**成為團隊的一員**。」

Practice 21

> “The village became part of the city.”

「這條村後來**成為城市的一部分**。」

become part/member of = 身份 / 結構上開始屬於某個群體或整體

11. **become = develop into (變成) — 演變成 ; 發展成**

A broad transformation use.

Practice 22

> “The small business **became a large company**.”

「那間小企業後來**發展成一家大公司**。」

Practice 23

> “The discussion became an argument.”

「討論後來**演變成爭吵**。」

become X = 某人 / 某事經過變化後成為新的形態、身份或結果

12. **become = grow into a new condition (逐漸變成) — 演變；發展**

Practice 24

> “The issue **became a major problem**.”

「這個問題後來**變成了重大問題**。」

Practice 25

> “The hobby became a career.”

「那個興趣後來**發展成了職業**。」

become = 某件事經過時間逐步轉化為另一種狀態 / 角色

13. **what became of...? (後來怎樣了？) — 後來發生甚麼事**

A genuinely separate idiomatic use.

Practice 26

> “What **became of** your old neighbour?”

「你以前那位鄰居**後來怎樣了？**」

Practice 27

> “Do you know what became of that project?”

「你知道那個項目**後來怎樣了嗎？**」

what became of X? = X 後來的命運 / 結果是甚麼

This is more formal or literary than:

> What happened to X?

14. **become of someone/something (某人 / 某事後來的結果) — 後來怎樣**

Practice 28

> “No one knows what **became of** the missing document.”

「沒有人知道那份失蹤文件**後來去了哪裡 / 結果如何**。」

Practice 29

> “I often wonder what became of my old classmates.”

「我常常想以前的同學們**後來都怎樣了**。」

become of = 表示某人 / 某事之後的命運、結果或去向

15. **become = suit / look attractive on someone (適合 ; 襯) — 很襯 ; 適合**

A genuine but more formal/literary verb sense.

Meaning: To make someone look attractive or suit their appearance.

Practice 30

> “That colour really **becomes you**.”

「那個顏色真的很**襯你**。」

Practice 31

> “The style becomes her.”

「那種風格很**適合 / 很襯她**。」

something becomes someone = 某種衣著、顏色、風格令某人看起來更好看 / 很相襯

This is established but less common in everyday speech than:

> suit.

16. **becoming = attractive / suitable (得體的 ; 相襯的) — 合適 ; 好看的**

A separate adjective use.

Practice 32

> “She wore a **becoming dress**.”

「她穿了一條很**襯她 / 很得體的裙子**。」

Practice 33

> “The colour is very becoming on you.”

「這個顏色穿在你身上很**好看 / 很襯你**。」

becoming = 衣著、顏色、風格等令人看起來更吸引 / 得體

This is somewhat formal/old-fashioned in everyday modern English, but still recognizable.

17. **becoming** = appropriate to someone's role/status (得體的) — 合乎身份 ; 恰當

A more formal extension.

Practice 34

> “She behaved with dignity **becoming her position**.”

「她的舉止端莊 , **符合她的身份**。」

Practice 35

> “His behaviour was not becoming of a professional.”

「他的行為**不符合專業人士應有的身份 / 不夠得體**。」

becoming = 與某人的身份、地位或場合相稱 / 得體

Formal and lower-frequency.

18. **unbecoming** (不得體的 ; 不相稱的) — 不合適 ; 有失身份

A useful opposite family form.

Practice 36

> “That behaviour was **unbecoming**.”

「那種行為很**不得體**。」

Practice 37

> “His comments were unbecoming of a manager.”

「他的言論**有失經理身份 / 不得體**。」

****unbecoming = 不符合某人的身份、角色或適當行為標準****

Formal.

Important distinction: **become vs get**

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

**become**

= neutral to formal change of state.

**get**

= very common conversational alternative for many adjective changes.

Compare:

> “It became cold.”

> “It got cold.”

Both mean:

> 天氣變冷了。

But ****get**** is more conversational.

Important distinction: **become vs turn**

**become**

= broad general change of state.

turn

often works with especially noticeable changes:

- > turn red
- > turn cold
- > turn bitter

Compare:

- > “He became angry.”

neutral.

- > “His face turned red.”

very natural physical change.

Important distinction: **become vs grow**

grow + adjective

often emphasizes gradual change over time.

- > “She grew tired.”

- > “They grew closer.”

become

is broader and does not itself specify speed.

- > “She became tired.”

Could happen gradually or quickly.

Important distinction: **become vs change**

change

= broad verb meaning become different.

become

requires a resulting state/identity:

- > become angry
- > become a teacher

You cannot normally say:

- >  become the plan

when you mean:

- > change the plan.

Important distinction: **become vs turn into**

become

works especially well for:

- * qualities;
- * roles;
- * identities;
- * states.

turn into

often emphasizes transformation from one thing into another.

- > “The discussion became an argument.”

- > “The caterpillar turned into a butterfly.”

Both can describe transformation, but **turn into** is often more vivid.

Important distinction: **become + adjective vs become + noun**

Adjective:

- > “She became **bitter**.”

= her state/quality changed.

Noun:

> “She became **a teacher**.”

= her identity/role changed.

Same verb, different complement type.

Important distinction: **become bitter** vs **be bitter**

be bitter

= describes the current state.

become bitter

= emphasizes the transition into that state.

Your passage specifically emphasizes:

> hardship did not **cause a change** in her character.

That is why **become** matters.

Important distinction: **become** vs **remain**

These are conceptual opposites in many contexts.

become

= change into a new state.

remain

= continue in the same state.

Your grandmother:

> faced hardship

but instead of:

> becoming bitter,

she:

> remained kind.

This is the key contrast.

Important distinction: **become vs stay**

stay

= continue in the same state, often conversational.

become

= transition to a different state.

> become calm

= 變得冷靜.

> stay calm

= 保持冷靜.

Important distinction: **become clear vs understand**

become clear

= the situation/information gradually becomes understandable.

understand

= the person grasps it.

> "It became clear that she was right."

focuses on the evidence/situation.

> “I understood that she was right.”

focuses on the thinker.

Important distinction: ****become aware vs know****

****become aware****

= transition from not knowing/not noticing to awareness.

****know****

= already possess the knowledge.

So:

> become aware

contains a change-of-state meaning.

Important distinction: ****become famous vs be famous****

****become famous****

= process/transition into fame.

****be famous****

= current state of fame.

Again:

> change vs state.

Important distinction: ****become a teacher vs work as a teacher****

****become a teacher****

= transition into the profession/identity.

work as a teacher

= currently perform that job.

Someone can become a teacher at one point and work as one for decades.

Important distinction: **become friends vs make friends**

become friends

= the relationship changes so two people are now friends.

make friends

= form friendships, often as an intentional/social process.

> “We became friends.”

focuses on resulting relationship.

Important distinction: **what became of...? vs what happened to...?**

What happened to...?

= normal everyday expression.

What became of...?

= more formal/literary, often asking about someone's eventual fate or outcome.

> “Whatever became of him?”

can sound reflective or nostalgic.

Important distinction: **become someone vs become like someone**

become a teacher

= identity/role literally changes.

become like her mother

= become similar in qualities/behaviour.

Do not confuse identity with resemblance.

Important distinction: **become you vs become like you**

This is a major trap.

That colour becomes you.

= 那個顏色很襯你。

He became like you.

= 他變得像你。

Completely different meanings.

Important distinction: **becoming adjective vs becoming verb form**

Compare:

> “She is **becoming tired**.”

Here:

becoming = verb; 正在變累。

But:

> “That dress is very **becoming**.”

Here:

becoming = adjective; 很襯 / 很得體。

Same form, different lexical function.

Important distinction: **becoming** vs **attractive**

attractive

= generally pleasant/beautiful.

becoming

= specifically suits someone and improves their appearance.

A dress can be attractive in itself but not becoming on a particular person.

Important distinction: **becoming** vs **appropriate**

In the formal “conduct” sense:

becoming

= suitable to one’s role/status.

appropriate

= suitable to the situation generally.

Becoming is more formal and person/status-oriented.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **become** family is relatively compact:

* **become + adjective** = 變得.....

* **become tired/angry/bitter** = 變得疲倦 / 生氣 / 怨恨

* **become clear/obvious** = 變得清楚 / 明顯

* **become aware** = 開始意識到

* **become famous/popular** = 成名 / 變得受歡迎

* **become + noun** = 成為.....

* **become a teacher/parent/leader** = 成為老師 / 父母 / 領袖

* **become friends** = 成為朋友

* **become part/member of** = 成為.....的一部分 / 成員

* **become X — develop into** = 演變 / 發展成.....

* **what became of...?** =後來怎樣了？

* **become someone — suit** = 很襯某人 / 適合某人
 * **becoming — attractive/suitable** = 得體 / 相襯
 * **unbecoming** = 不得體 / 有失身份

The main semantic branches are:

- > **change into a new state**
- > **enter a new role or identity**
- > **develop into a different form/result**
- > **what later happened to someone/something**
- > **suit someone's appearance**

plus the adjective:

- > **becoming = attractive/suitable**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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become + adjective	由原本狀態轉變成具有某種新性質 / 狀況
become tired/angry/bitter	身體、情緒或心理狀態發生改變
become clear/obvious	原本不清楚 / 不明顯的事情逐漸可以理解 / 看出
become aware	由不知道 / 未察覺轉變為知道 / 察覺
become famous/popular	開始具有名氣 / 受歡迎的社會狀態
become + noun	開始擁有某種身份、角色、職業或地位
become friends	人際關係轉變為朋友關係
become part/member of	開始在身份 / 結構上屬於某群體或整體
become = develop into	某事經過變化後演變 / 發展成另一種形態或結果
what became of...?	詢問某人 / 某事後來的命運、結果或去向
become someone — suit	某種衣著、顏色或風格很適合 / 很襯某人
becoming — adjective	衣著、顏色或舉止與某人相襯、得體
unbecoming	與某人的身份 / 角色不相稱、不夠得體

For your original passage

- > “I also admire the way she has handled hardship in life without **becoming bitter**.”

The exact meaning is:

****become = begin to be / change into a new state****

Therefore:

> ****becoming bitter****

= ****「逐漸變得怨恨、憤憤不平」****

The verb is important because the sentence is about the ****effect hardship could have had on her character****.

It does not merely say:

> she is not bitter.

It says:

> hardship happened

> → it could have changed her

> → but she did not become bitter.

So the conceptual contrast is:

> ****become bitter****

> = change into a resentful state

versus:

> ****remain kind / warm / patient****

> = continue possessing those positive qualities.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****become tired****

> = 變累

> ****become angry****

> = 變得生氣

> ****become clear****

> = 變得清楚

> ****become aware****

> = 開始意識到

> **become famous**

> = 成名

> **become a teacher**

> = 成為老師

> **become friends**

> = 成為朋友

> **become a problem**

> = 演變成問題

> **What became of him?**

> = 他後來怎樣了？

> **That colour becomes you.**

> = 那個顏色很襯你。（較正式）

> **a becoming dress**

> = 很襯 / 很得體的裙子

So **become** is broader than simply:

> **become = 成為**

and in your original passage it specifically means:

***“to undergo an emotional change and start being resentful — a change that hardship did not cause in her.”**